

requested site—in this case, the client has requested the resource `/stuff.html`, which means that the file asked for is an HTML file and not a file in the `.gif` or `.tiff` format. The second bit of information that we get from the filename field is that the client used the protocol HTTP/1.0 to access the file.

Note that the Method field and filename field information are always presented in double quotes.

7. Status field (200): The second-to-last number at the end of the line represents the response code of the request. This response code is basically a code that is a part of the HTTP protocol, and which shows how exactly a Web server handled a request. The status field, therefore indicates whether this particular request was successfully delivered by the server. Here, the code is 200, which indicates successful delivery of the file. This field is useful for detecting if a particular file has remained undelivered due to errors. Some of the typical status codes you'd see in the log are...

Code	What it means
200	Successful delivery of the file
404	File not found
302	Redirect to another file
401	Password required
500	Server error
400	Bad request

You're probably very used to seeing the message "404 not found," which appears when your request doesn't find the page you requested.

8. Size field: The field which specifies, in bytes, the size of the file that has been sent to the client. Typically, Web server software report the size of the file served. In this case, it is 16,716 bytes.

2.2.4 Analysing Log Files

So now that you know what log files actually represent, it's easy to understand what the owners of Web sites could do with this data: they can learn about their audience and their information needs. By following the path—the links—that people take while going